



Have you ever seen a turtle with spots? If yes, you've probably met a spotted turtle! These cute little creatures are small, with their shell (or 'carapace') usually only reaching 4 to 6 inches in length. Their shells are dark, almost black, and decorated with bright yellow or orange spots that make them easy to recognize. And you know what's even more interesting? No two spotted turtles have the same pattern of spots!



Now that you're familiar with their looks, let's dive into where these unique turtles call home. Spotted turtles inhabit a wide range of habitats across North America, from southern Ontario in Canada down to Florida in the United States. They love hanging out in wet areas like marshes, swamps, and even in the shallow parts of lakes and streams. But they're also known to wander on land, especially when they're looking for a mate or a place to lay their eggs.

Speaking of eggs, let's hatch some knowledge about the spotted turtle's life cycle. Like other turtles, spotted turtles lay eggs that hatch into tiny turtles, but they lay fewer eggs than most other turtle species, usually only three to five at a time. The eggs develop and hatch over the summer, and the baby turtles grow into adults over a period of several years. Spotted turtles can live a long time, often up to 50 years or more!



truly unique and fascinating creature!

Now, let's shell-ebrate some cool facts about our spotty friends and their relationship with humans and other animals. They are known to be friendly and even curious about humans, but sadly, their numbers are declining due to habitat loss and being captured for the pet trade. As for other animals, spotted turtles are omnivores, which means they eat both plants and animals like insects, worms, and small fish. Finally, their colorful spots aren't just for show, they also serve as a warning to predators that these turtles are not to be messed with. So, that's our spotted turtle — a



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) Are spotted turtles friendly towards humans?
A. No, they are scared of humans B. No, they are always aggressive
C. They never interact with humans D. Yes, they are known to be friendly
- 2) What parts of a spotted turtle are usually decorated with bright yellow or orange spots?
A. Their eyes B. Their heads and limbs
C. Their shell (or 'carapace') D. Their belly
- 3) Where do spotted turtles live?
A. Asia B. North America C. South America D. Africa
- 4) How long can spotted turtles live?
A. Up to 30 years B. Up to 10 years
C. Up to 50 years or more D. Up to 20 years
- 5) What type of areas do spotted turtles prefer?
A. Cold areas B. Dry areas C. Wet areas D. High mountain areas
- 6) What color are the spots on a spotted turtle's shell?
A. Bright yellow or orange B. Red and green
C. Deep blue D. Dull gray
- 7) How many eggs do spotted turtles usually lay at a time?
A. Six to eight B. Three to five C. One to two D. Nine to eleven
- 8) Under what circumstances would spotted turtles leave the water?
A. When they're hungry B. When they want to play
C. When looking for a place to lay eggs D. When it's too hot
- 9) What kind of diet do spotted turtles have?
A. They are omnivores B. They are herbivores
C. They are carnivores D. They are insectivores
- 10) What is a reason the number of spotted turtles declining?
A. Habitat loss B. Lack of predators
C. Disease D. Overpopulation
- 11) What is the usual length of a spotted turtle's shell?
A. 10 to 12 inches B. 4 to 6 inches C. 1 to 2 feet D. 1 to 3 inches

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 12) "We are quite afraid of humans and tend to stay away."
- 13) "In the wild, I normally hang around marshes, swamps, lakes, and streams."
- 14) "We spotted turtles only live for few years, just a decade or so."
- 15) "Dry desert is my favorite place, you'll never find me in wet areas."



- 46) It's important to protect their habitat.
A. it is
C. it will
B. it has
D. it was
- 47) They're usually found near shallow water.
A. they have
C. they are
B. they were
D. they will

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 48) Spotted turtles can live for over 50 years in the wild.
- 49) Are spotted turtles endangered?
- 50) Spotted turtles are omnivores and eat a variety of foods, including plants and small insects.
- 51) Spotted turtles live in freshwater habitats, like marshes and ponds.
- 52) How do spotted turtles get their name?
- 53) Where can spotted turtles be found in the wild?



Spotted Turtle

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Spotted Turtle

Name: _____

- | | | | | | |
|-----|----------------|-----|----------------------|-----|----------------------|
| 1. | <u>D</u> | 26. | <u>opinion</u> | 51. | <u>declarative</u> |
| 2. | <u>C</u> | 27. | <u>fact</u> | 52. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 3. | <u>B</u> | 28. | <u>opinion</u> | 53. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 4. | <u>C</u> | 29. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 5. | <u>C</u> | 30. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 6. | <u>A</u> | 31. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 7. | <u>B</u> | 32. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 8. | <u>C</u> | 33. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 9. | <u>A</u> | 34. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 10. | <u>A</u> | 35. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 11. | <u>B</u> | 36. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 12. | <u>Not</u> | 37. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 13. | <u>Would</u> | 38. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 14. | <u>Not</u> | 39. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 15. | <u>Not</u> | 40. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 16. | <u>Would</u> | 41. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 17. | <u>Not</u> | 42. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 18. | <u>Would</u> | 43. | <u>B</u> | | |
| 19. | <u>Would</u> | 44. | <u>A</u> | | |
| 20. | <u>Not</u> | 45. | <u>D</u> | | |
| 21. | <u>Not</u> | 46. | <u>A</u> | | |
| 22. | <u>Would</u> | 47. | <u>C</u> | | |
| 23. | <u>fact</u> | 48. | <u>declarative</u> | | |
| 24. | <u>opinion</u> | 49. | <u>interrogative</u> | | |
| 25. | <u>fact</u> | 50. | <u>declarative</u> | | |